

Become a Web designer

Did you always want to create and design your own websites? We put the spotlight on a career designing websites

Industry Connect

We talk about the storage sector trends and more with Gordon Wu of Transcend Inc



Speed Up Your Work

Small changes to your working style and the right office hardware makes you more efficient at work

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In a digitally connected workplace, the advent of technology and the Internet is both a blessing and a curse. The danger is that of getting set in routines that don't keep pace with time, thereby hampering your efficiency at work. Technology and the Web also has its distractions that most office goers find difficulty in resisting, especially after the lunch break – productivity goes downhill after lunch for all of us, doesn't it? However, we aren't trying to fix the world and human nature here, but merely attempting to give a few pointers on how making subtle changes on the way you work and the instruments you work with can help you achieve a lot more, not to mention freshen things up as far as the regular work routine is concerned. As a small business owner, these tips should help you get the most out of your small office workforce, including yourself.

Dual monitors

This is one thing you need to get done soon. If you still work on a good ol' CRT monitor from yesteryear, then you have to switch to a contemporary 22-inch full-HD display at the minimum. While a 22-inch LCD monitor may offer a cool 1920x1080 pixel resolution, you can always decide to spend more and buy a 27-inch display screen with up to 2540x1440 pixel resolution. But what's better than one HD monitor? Two HD monitors!

To have acres of pixels to play with on a computer display makes organizing and getting through your work that much quicker. Imagine trying to work on different spreadsheets side-by-side instead of constantly minimizing-maximizing several program windows – while the former is possible on a large-screen monitor or dual-display setup, the latter is an irritating, inefficient way to work. If you write a lot of original articles, having one monitor exclusively for researching is just a lot more convenient than tiny, squeezed windows on your screen. Also remember that buying two 22-inch HD monitors is cheaper than most 27-inch displays, and their combined screen area is easily greater.

Take control of the Web

We may sound too harsh when we say that Facebook, LinkedIn, Twitter and e-commerce websites are among the most-visited during office hours and through work machines, but several trusted surveys agree. To keep your small office employees engaged in work and off time-wasting websites, it is necessary to consider the following plan of action.

At some level, you have to concede that employees will waste some time online, so there's no point going all autocratic on your workforce. Impress upon yourself and others the importance of taking "Facebook breaks" just like having a tea, coffee or smoking breaks at a workplace. If you think your employees aren't tech-savvy enough, you can get away by adding something like StayFocused, a popular browser extension. It's a simple yet highly configurable tool to help you allot "time-wasting windows" in a typical work day, picking on specific sites to block. After you or an employee uses up their non-work-related online breaks, they can't access those websites (or any website that you have designated) for the rest of the day. Through StayFocused, you can even ban the rest of the Web,